



MyBCIT UI/UX Re- design: UX Case Study

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USER RESEARCH



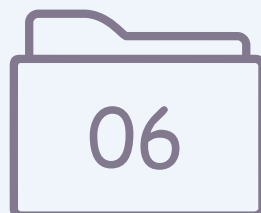
**DESIGN PROCESS &
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BEFORE VS AFTER



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I: Summary

BCIT built its reputation on being fast-paced and hands-on, the kind of school that prepares students for real work, not just theory. MyBCIT, the portal every student depends on daily, doesn't reflect that at all. It's outdated, confusing to navigate, and the gap between the school's actual identity and its digital front door is hard to miss once you notice it.

This project set out to close that gap: over ten interviews, several rounds of prototyping, and usability testing shaped a redesign that cuts down navigation complexity and improves accessibility, while still looking unmistakably like BCIT, not a generic template that happens to use their colours.

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2: USER RESEARCH

WHOM I INTERVIEWED:

Before interviewing anyone, I checked the BCIT subreddit, mostly out of curiosity, and found people actively venting about the platform without me even asking. That told me something important early on: this wasn't a minor annoyance a few people had; it was widespread enough that students were bringing it up unprompted. That shaped whom I wanted to talk to.

HOW PEOPLE THINK ABOUT MYBCIT:

I interviewed three different groups: current students who use MyBCIT regularly, graduates who remembered what it used to be like, and people who'd never seen the platform before. That last group mattered more than I expected. Current students had gotten used to workarounds without realizing it, so the only way to really test how approachable the interface was meant to be was by bringing in someone with completely fresh eyes.

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2: USER RESEARCH

QUESTIONS I ASKED:

I wanted questions that would surface specific friction, not just general opinions, since "I don't like it" doesn't tell you what actually to fix. So alongside asking how people felt about MyBCIT, I asked about concrete tasks and behaviours: what they avoid, how long something takes, whether they'd even want a new feature like AI support. The specifics mattered more than the feelings. Are you familiar with MyBCIT, and how often do you use it?

- Which features do you actually use, and which ones do you tend to avoid?
- How would you rate MyBCIT in terms of ease of use?
- What are the biggest frustrations you have when using it?
- How long does it usually take you to find your grades?
- Would something like an AI support assistant make the experience better for you?

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2: USER RESEARCH

By the fourth or fifth interview, I could predict what someone was about to say before they said it. The complaints weren't scattered; they converged on the same handful of problems:

- **There are way too many steps just to get to basic pages like grades, with participants reporting an average of six or more clicks to reach their academic information**
- **Important information is buried under tabs and sections that are not relevant to students**
- **The platform has a steep learning curve and is not welcoming to new students at all**
- **The visual design feels inconsistent and well behind the standards of modern websites**
- **Getting support through email takes far too long and feels outdated as a system**

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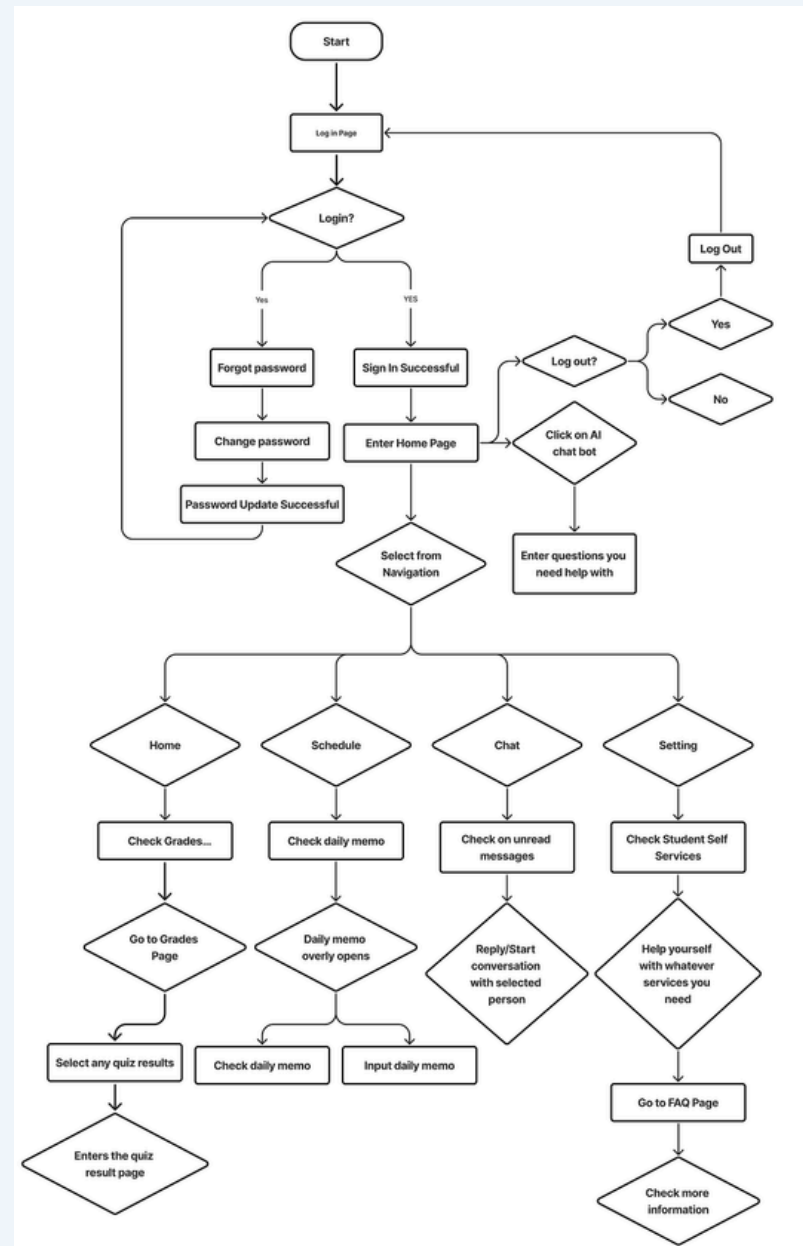
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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR

That convergence was the whole redesign brief, really. If five different complaints all point to the same root cause, being buried and hard to reach, then the fix isn't five separate features; it's one priority: get key information in front of people faster. That's really Hick's Law in practice: the more choices and steps someone has to wade through, the longer and harder a decision becomes. Cutting click depth wasn't just a nice metric to report; it was directly reducing that cognitive load. Alongside that, the visual system needed to feel like it belonged to 2024, not two decades ago.

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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR

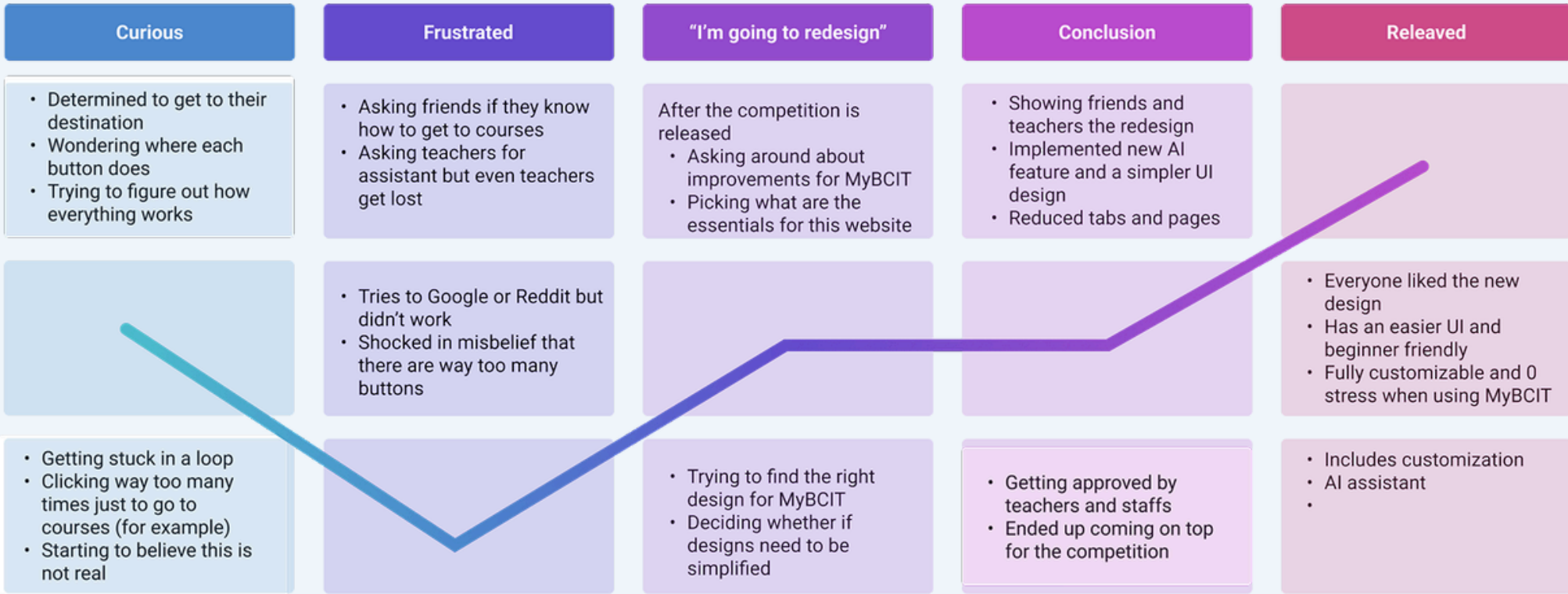


The redesigned flowchart directly addresses the clicking overload participants identified during testing. Features such as grade checking, a daily memo overlay, an integrated chat function, and course information displayed directly on the home page were added to meet students' actual needs, while also modernizing MyBCIT's platform without compromising its existing brand identity.

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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR



Mapping the emotional arc alongside the interviews reinforced the same pattern: curiosity turning into frustration over too many clicks and dead ends, then relief once the new design cut through the clutter. That shift, from stressed to beginner-friendly, is what the redesign was ultimately solving for.

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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR

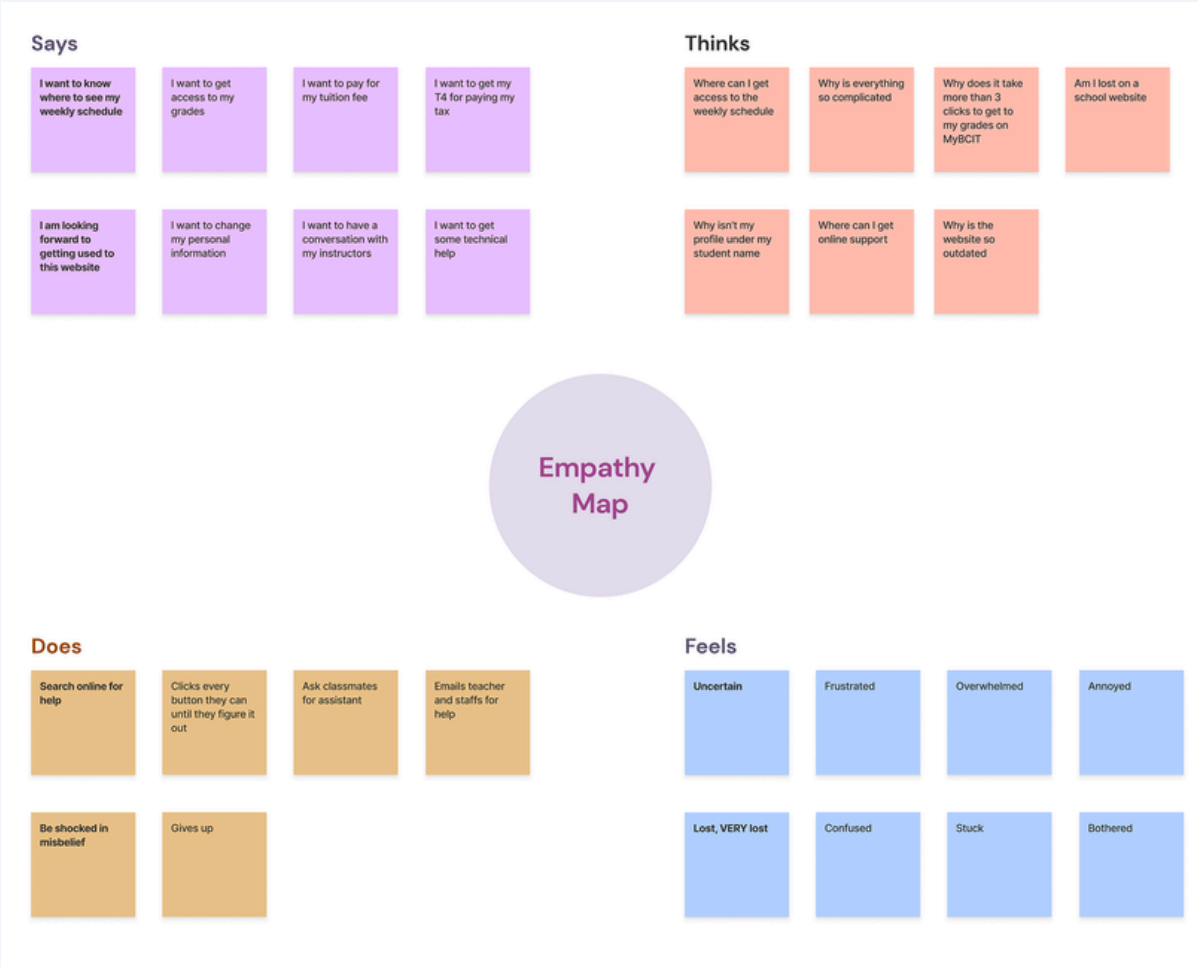
These opportunities came straight from the research, not guesswork. Each one traces back to something a participant said or struggled with: fewer buttons, a real chat feature instead of email, grades shown with class averages, calendar options that actually fit how students plan their time.

- **Simpler UI for all users**
- **Fewer buttons and tabs for a beginner-friendly experience**
- **More useful assistant options, fewer irrelevant ones**
- **Minimalistic design over a cramped interface**
- **More personalized customization**
- **A dedicated FAQ page**
- **Chat feature for students and teachers, more efficient than email**
- **Group chat and picture upload support**
- **Easier grade checking, with class average and feedback included**
- **Monthly calendar instead of weekly**
- **Assignments and quizzes addable directly in calendar notes**

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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR



The empathy map pulled these patterns together in one place: what students said they wanted, what they were actually thinking and feeling, and what they did when stuck, searching online, clicking blindly, or giving up entirely. Seeing 'frustrated' and 'lost, VERY lost' sitting next to 'why does it take more than 3 clicks to get to my grades' made the connection between emotion and interface friction hard to ignore.

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Personas like Jimmy grounded the research in a specific person rather than an abstract user group. His goals, efficient access to information, a personalized experience, reduced learning curve, map directly onto the redesign decisions: fewer clicks to grades, a simplified menu, and features tailored to what students actually asked for.

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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR



Jimmy

About

-  Computer Science Diploma Program
-  23
-  Vancouver, Canada
-  Student at BCIT

About

Jimmy is a 23 year old student who enrolled in BCIT. He has heard a lot of good things about BCIT and looks forward to become one of the best developers in Canada. Jimmy met a lot of friends at BCIT with no problems. He never thought the main issue at BCIT was the MyBCIT website. He was able to change and redesign MyBCIT into something that calling it an upgrade is an understatement.

Goals

- Efficient access to information
- Effective course management
- Clear communication channels
- Personalized experience
- Access to resources and support
- Reduce learning curve

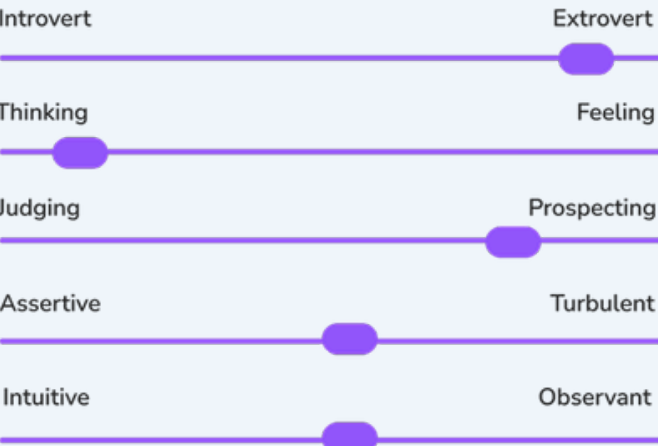
Pain Points

- Technical issues and bugs
- Difficult interface navigations
- Overwhelming amount of information
- Complex learning curve(s)

Interests

Other than school and learning, Jimmy enjoys video gaming with his friends whenever he has the chance to. He loves to observe how each character moves and the possible animation codes that were used to make a movement happen. In another words, Jimmy is a complete geek. In addition, he also enjoys playing basketball with his friends. It is his favorite way to socialize with others.

Personality



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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR

Jimmy Ho is a first-year Computer Science student at BCIT. He arrived with high expectations, and the people lived up to them; he quickly found a talented, supportive circle of friends. The platform did not. Despite asking family, friends, and even ChatGPT for help, Jimmy could never quite figure out how to navigate MyBCIT and resorted to clicking around and taking notes just to find what he needed. When BCIT announced a campus-wide competition to redesign the outdated platform, Jimmy saw an opportunity to fix the exact problem he had been living with for weeks. He partnered with a group of friends skilled in design and development, and their collaboration paid off: the redesign placed first in the competition and became the new face of MyBCIT.

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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR

Accessibility came from a similar place: listening rather than assuming. Testing surfaced something I hadn't fully anticipated: several participants specifically needed larger text and stronger contrast to comfortably use the platform. Once that came up, I checked the colour pairings against WCAG contrast guidelines directly, rather than relying on gut feeling, since "looks fine to me" isn't the same as actually meeting a real accessibility standard. That wasn't a nice-to-have I added at the end; it reshaped earlier decisions about type scale and colour pairing well before the visual design was finalized.

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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR

Every stage fed the next one directly. Brand research told me what I couldn't change: the colours, the sense of institutional trust BCIT already had. Sketching let me test navigation ideas quickly, before getting attached to anything. Low-fidelity wireframes were where the click-reduction goal actually got tested for the first time, and multiple rounds of high fidelity in Figma were less about polish and more about making sure the accessibility changes held up once real content and spacing were in play, not just in a rough sketch. Nothing here was decorative; every stage existed because the previous one revealed something that needed solving.

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3: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOUR

COLOUR PALETTE:

0A345E

Main colour

FDEB5B

Secondary colour

ffffff

Background colour

000000

Fonts/Letters

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4: USER TESTING RESULTS

Testing wasn't just showing people the new design and asking if they liked it; it was watching them actually try to use it. The same three groups from earlier came back for this round: current students, graduates, and complete newcomers, working through real tasks like finding grades or navigating to student services. Watching where someone hesitated told me more than anything they said out loud.

A few reactions stood out:

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4: USER TESTING RESULTS

Emme

“I like how everything goes together well, especially the chatting options instead of email. If I had to say one thing I don’t like is the green that was used for the online status.”

From the same program

Courtney

“It looks good but I would want the message sending as an option. It’s making me want to click on everything, which is nice.”

From the same program

Kristian

“I love the buttons and how clear it is. It definitely looks more like a BCIT page now. I am more willing to use it if the interface looks like this.”

BCIT Graphic Design Program

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4: USER TESTING RESULTS

A BCIT Graduate

“It is cleaner and definitely an upgrade from the old one. It was too outdated and ugly.”

Do not know their program

BACK

A BCIT Graduate

“It definitely looks a lot more simple and I love how big the texts are. Super helpful for those who has reading problems and I like how there is the personalized option.”

Do not know their program

NEXT

4: USER TESTING RESULTS

Across the group, the pattern was clear: people responded strongly to the interface finally looking like it belonged to BCIT, and to small usability choices like chat over email. The one recurring note wasn't about the redesign's direction; it was smaller points of polish, colour choices, optional features, the kind of feedback that confirms the bigger decisions were already working.

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5: SUMMARY

I'd used MyBCIT for years without really questioning it; it was just the thing you complained about and moved past. This project forced me to actually sit with that frustration instead of shrugging at it, and trace it back to specific, fixable decisions rather than a vague sense that it was "bad."

None of the individual changes were dramatic. Fewer clicks to grades, larger text, consolidated navigation, on paper that's a modest list. But testing showed those small changes were the whole difference between a platform people tolerated and one they'd actually call approachable. That's probably the biggest thing this project taught me: the most important design decisions are often the least visible ones, the stuff nobody notices until it's finally fixed.

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5: SUMMARY

There's more I'd want to validate before calling this finished. A second, more structured round of usability testing would confirm whether the changes actually hold up under real use, not just first impressions. Tracking navigation patterns through heatmaps would show whether click depth genuinely dropped in practice, not just in theory. And the AI support idea participants brought up early on is worth exploring properly, though it raises real questions about handling sensitive student data responsibly, questions I'd want answered before building anything, not after.

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6: BEFORE VS AFTER

BEFORE

BCIT

Sign in

BCIT email

NEXT

[Forgot your BCIT email?](#)

The resource you've requested is restricted to BCIT students, staff or faculty only. Enter your BCIT email and password to continue.

Important

When finished your session, be sure to completely log out of all applications and close/quit all browsers. This will improve security and prevent others from using your access.

Need help?

If you are having trouble logging in, there may be an issue with your credentials (BCIT email and/or password). [Get help.](#)

By signing in, you agree to our [Acceptable Use and Security policies.](#)

[Copyright](#) [Privacy](#)

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AFTER

BCIT
BRITISH COLUMBIA
INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

BOTH FIELDS VISIBLE,
REDUCED STEPS TO LOGIN

Email

Password

Sign In

[Forgot password?](#)

Remember Me ☐

PERSONALISED
STUDENT PROFILE

Jimmy Ho

A12345678

Hide on Home Page ☐

Hide Status ☐

Student Self Services:

Update Personal Information

Check Grades

Program Status

View Tuition Fees

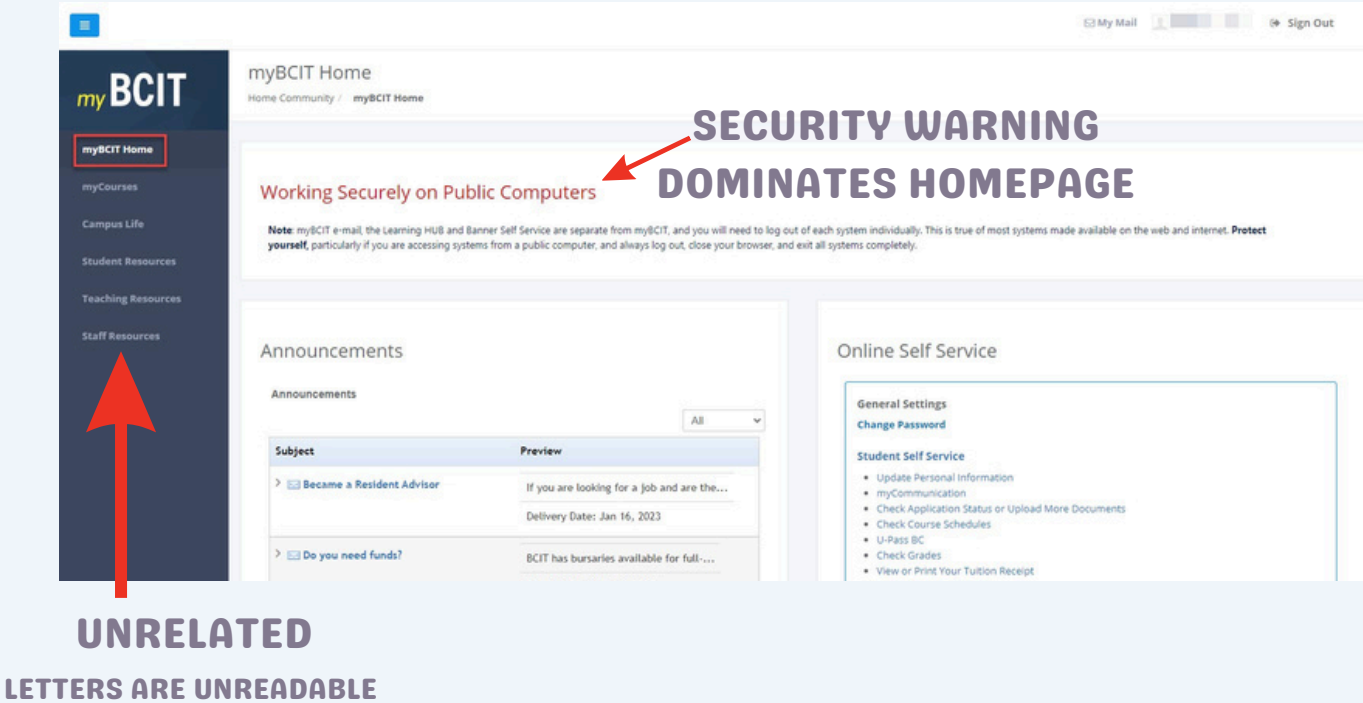
Order Official Transcripts

Log Out

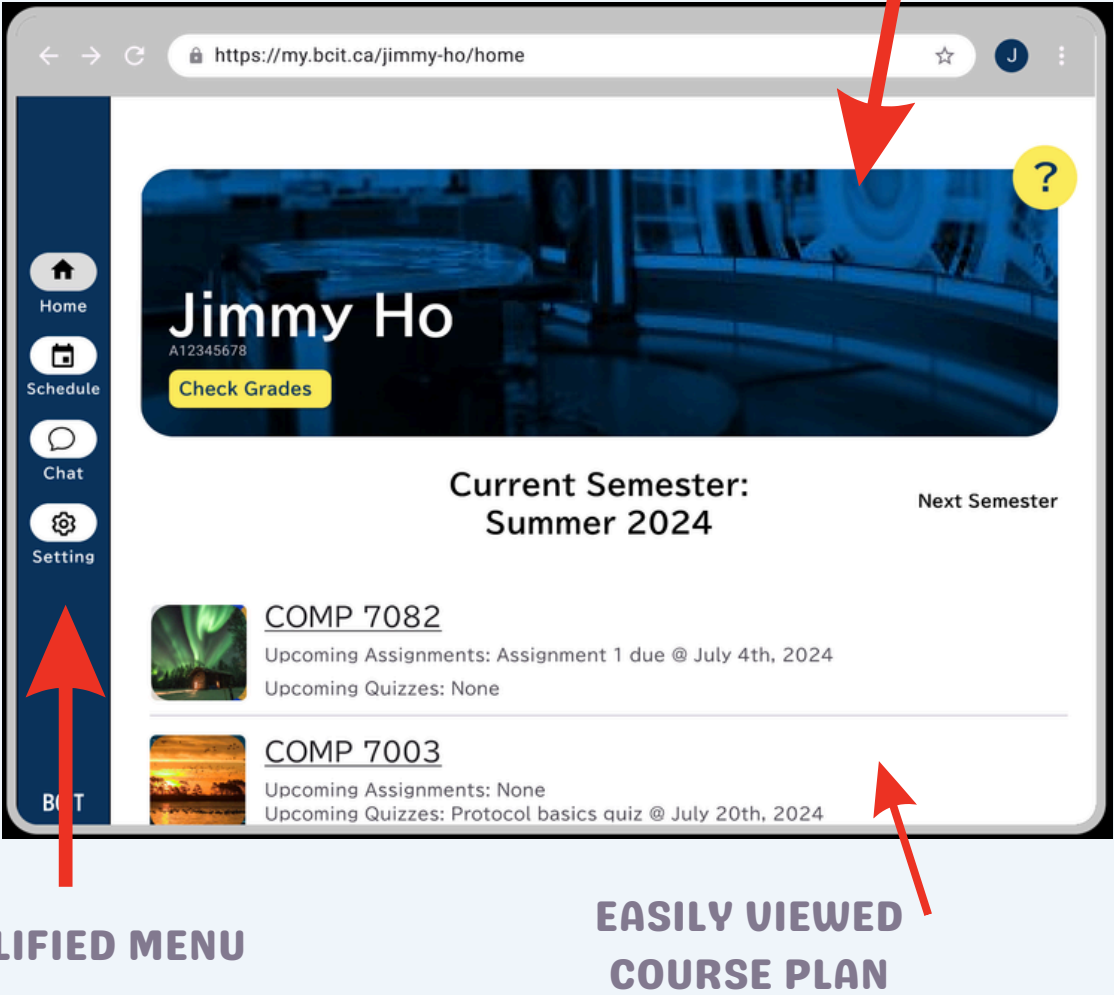
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6: BEFORE VS AFTER

BEFORE



AFTER

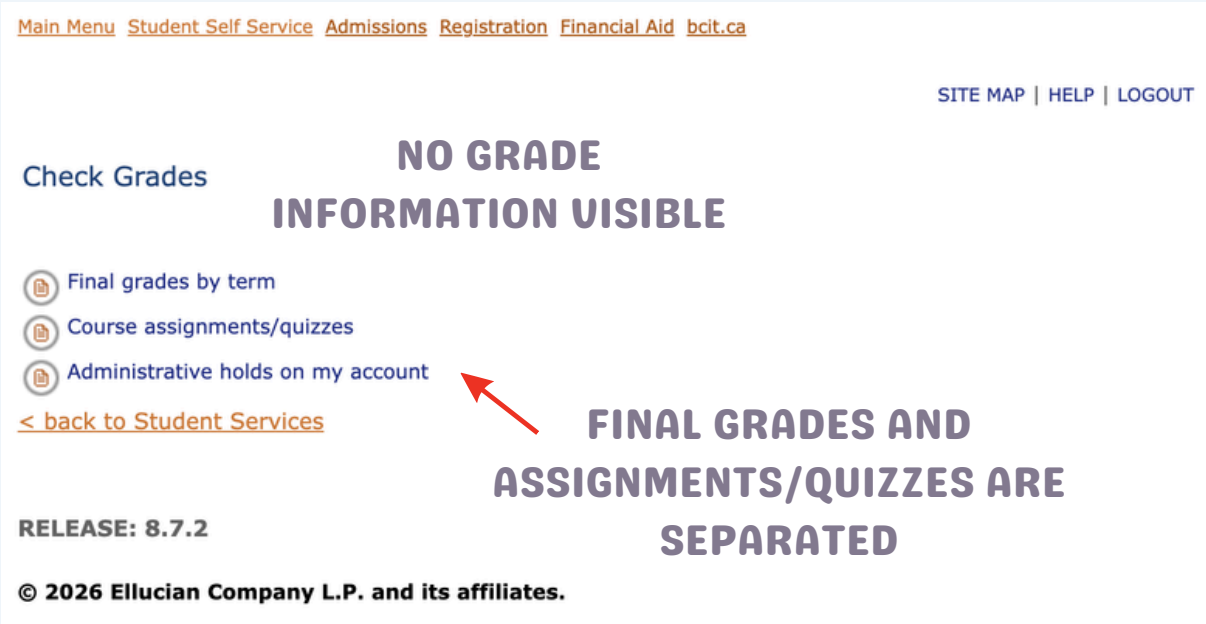


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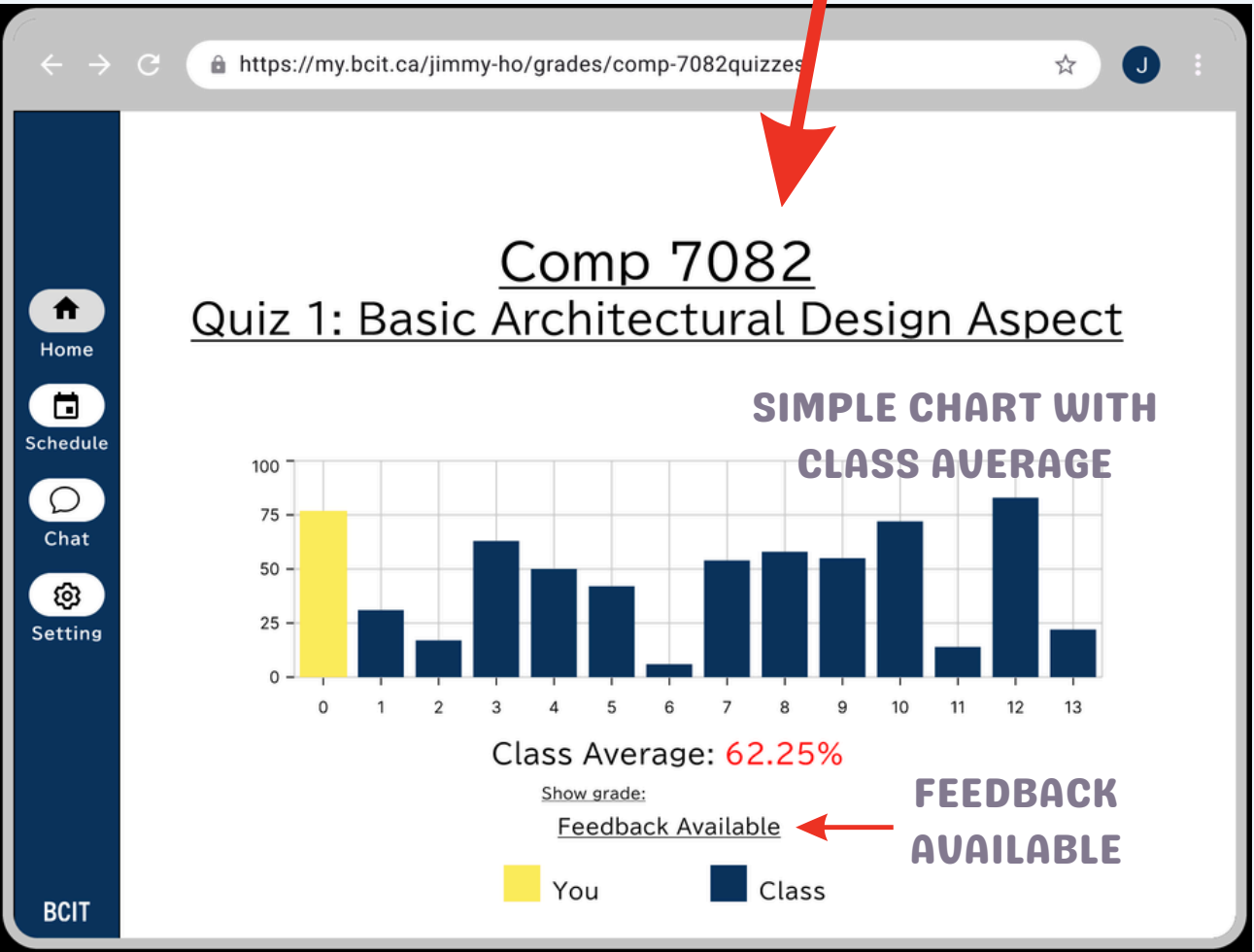
BEFORE



INTERFACE LAST UPDATED IN 2003 ERA DESIGN STANDARDS

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AFTER



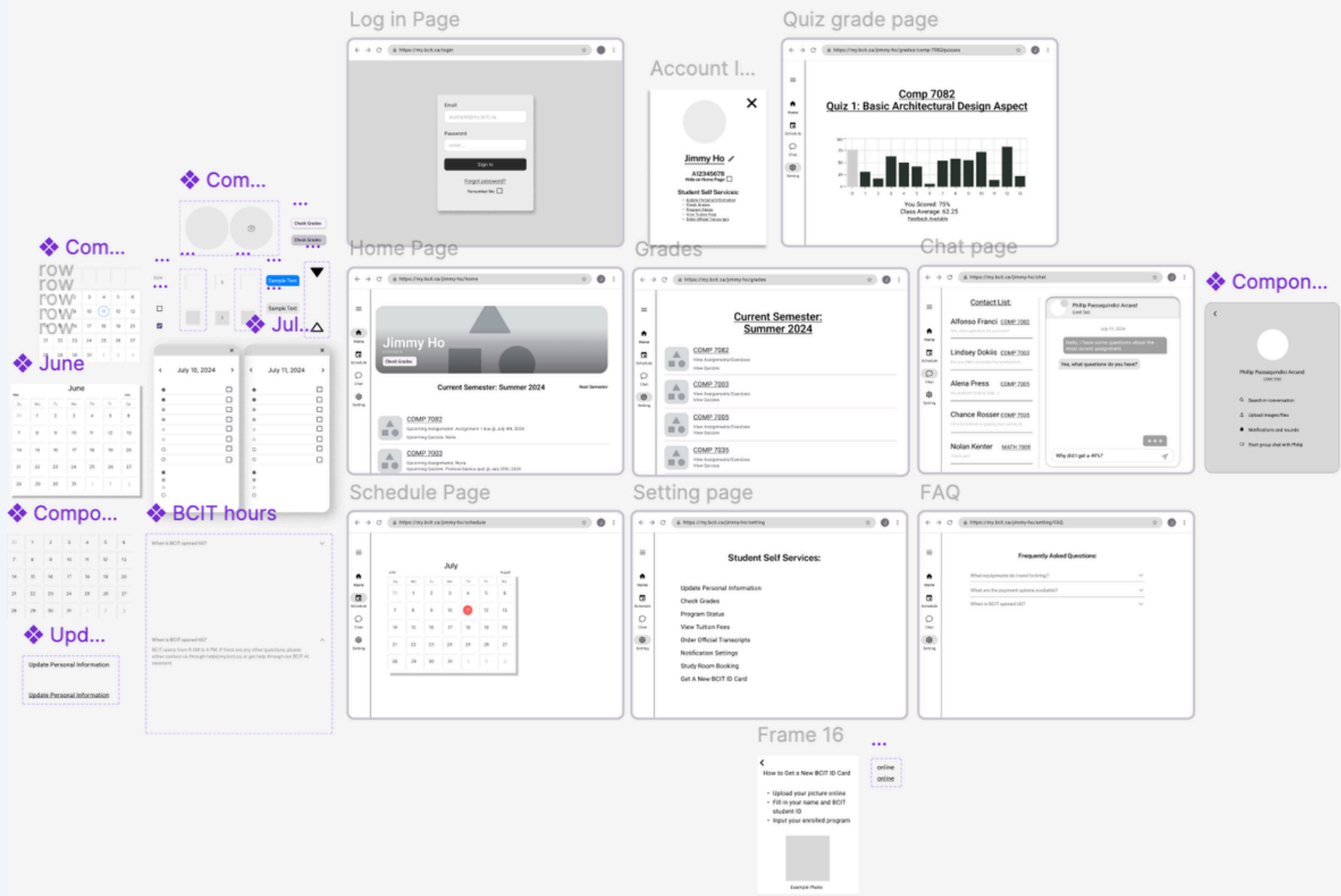
EYE-CATCHING COURSE AND QUIZ NAMES

FEEDBACK AVAILABLE

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7: SCREENSHOTS & LINK

LOW-FIDELITY

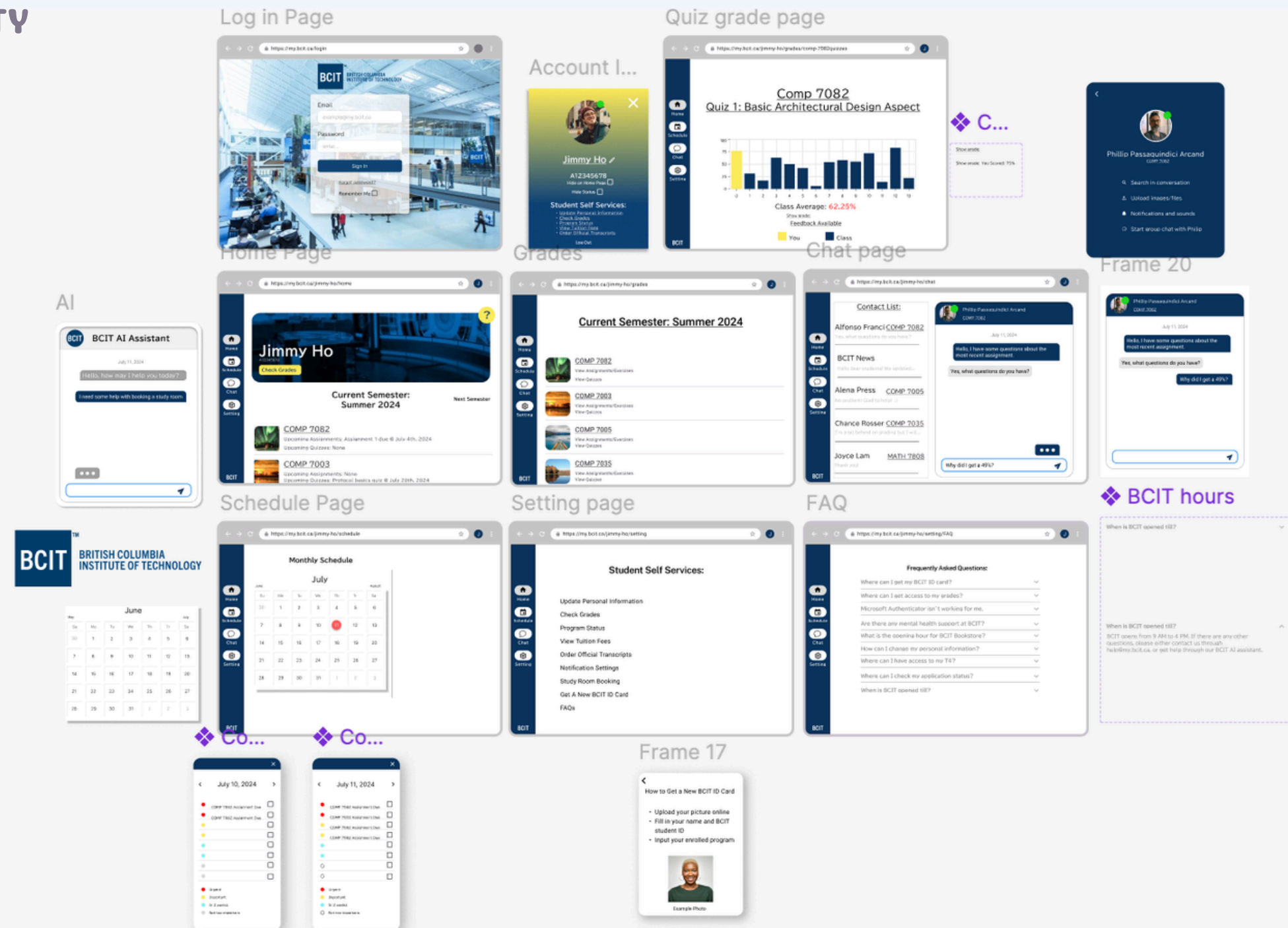


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7: SCREENSHOTS & LINK

HIGH-FIDELITY



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7: SCREENSHOTS & LINK

LINK TO FIGMA:

Figma Link:

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THANK YOU

by Sonya Yeh

